

Let's play the LT Pro 48.

The Life Time LT Pro 48 is the official ball of the PPA Tour and Major League Pickleball. Here's why it beats the Franklin X-40 on our courts.

FOUR REASONS

1. It doesn't crack as fast.

Cracks on a pickleball almost always start at the edge of a hole. The LT Pro 48 chamfers every hole edge to spread that stress. Fewer dead balls mid-game, fewer balls in the trash.

2. The bounce is true.

48 symmetrically spaced holes and two-piece injection molding give a uniform bounce of about 85 cm. No skips, no dead spots, no "that one was the ball's fault."

3. It survives our heat.

Balls soften and slow down in South Florida sun. The LT plays faster with a higher bounce, so a hot afternoon ball still plays like a ball.

4. It's what the pros play.

PPA Tour and MLP both use it. If you enter a PPA event, this is the ball you'll be handed. Practice on what you'll compete on.

HEAD TO HEAD

	LIFE TIME LT PRO 48	FRANKLIN X-40
Holes	48, evenly spaced, chamfered edges	40, machine drilled
Build	Two-piece injection molded, 26 g	One-piece rotationally molded
Feel	Fast, firm, high bounce	Softer and slower
Pro tours	Official ball of PPA Tour + MLP	USA Pickleball and US Open ball
Designed to fix	Cracking, bad bounces, and heat	The long-time rec-play standard

FAIR QUESTIONS

"The X-40 is the official USAP ball."

True. USA Pickleball sanctions with it. But the two biggest pro tours looked at the whole field and picked the LT.

"It plays too fast for me."

It is quicker off the paddle. Give it two sessions. Your resets and hands speed get sharper, not worse.

"It costs more per ball."

A cracked ball costs the whole group a game. Cost per hour of good play is what actually matters.

Try it before you argue: play one game with each, back to back. Same players, same wind, ten minutes apart.



Full page, sources, and the vote: balls.93.fyi

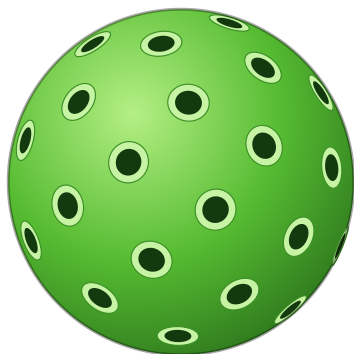
Specs and durability claims per Life Time and Pickleball Central product information; PPA Tour and MLP ball announcements, 2025 and 2026. Franklin X-40 specs per Pickleball Central product information. Ball feel is subjective, so run the test above.

SIDE BY SIDE. LOOK AT THE HOLES.

Same size ball. Very different build.

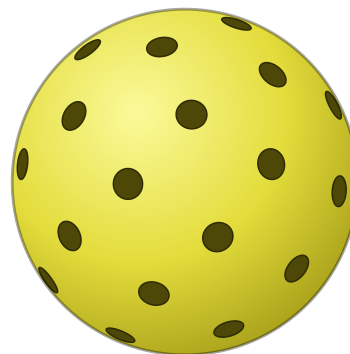
Both are 2.9 inches and tournament legal. Everything that matters is in the hole count, the hole edges, and how the shell is made.

Life Time LT Pro 48
48 HOLES / 26 G



- 48 holes, evenly spaced all the way around, so flight stays stable from any contact point.
- Chamfered hole edges. Each hole is beveled instead of sharp cut.
- Two-piece injection molded for tighter wall thickness control.

Franklin X-40
40 HOLES



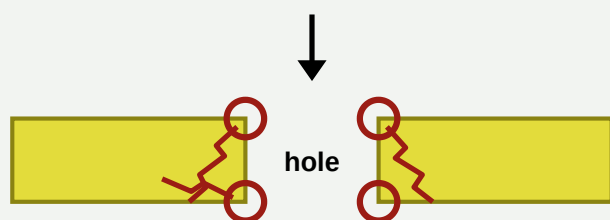
- 40 holes, drilled after molding, so a bit more air resistance and a slower ball.
- Square-cut hole edges left by the drill bit.
- One-piece rotationally molded, the older and cheaper process.

ZOOM IN

This is where a ball dies.

Square-cut hole: crack starts here

Impact load piles up on a 90 degree corner.

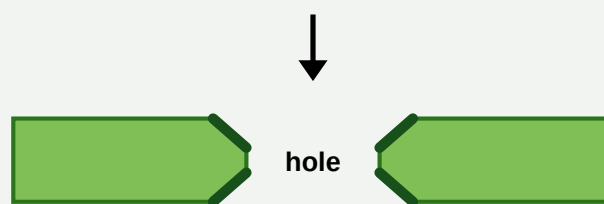


wall of the ball, seen edge on

Hit it hard enough, enough times, and the split runs hole to hole. That is the ball that goes soft and oval on you in the middle of a good point.

Chamfered hole: load spreads out

The bevel gives the force somewhere to go.



no sharp corner for a crack to start from

No sharp corner for a crack to start from. Life Time describes this design as patent-pending (2025) and built the whole ball around it. It is the single biggest reason the LT lasts longer in open play.

More holes. Softer edges. Truer bounce. Longer life.

Flip this sheet over for the head-to-head and the two-game test.

Ball illustrations are schematic, drawn to show hole count and edge geometry, not exact factory hole placement. About twenty holes of each ball are visible from any one side. Construction and patent details per Life Time and Pickleball Central product information; Franklin X-40 specs per Pickleball Central.